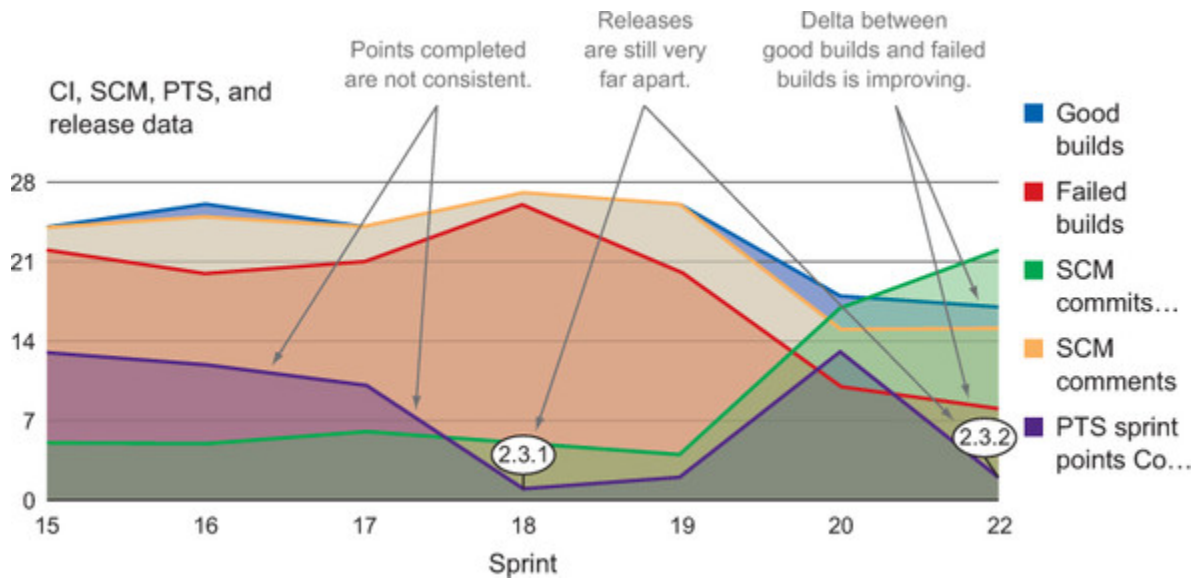
The second question was “Are you delivering more consistently?” In chapter 3 we talked about the fairly standard measure of agile consistency: velocity. Another data point that can be used to track consistency is good builds versus failed builds from the CI system. They added that to their charts as well, which output the graph shown in figure 5.16.

Figure 5.16. Adding velocity and releases to our case study



Based on the data shown here, there’s some bad news:

- Velocity isn’t consistent.
- Releases are far apart.

But there is good news too; the delta between good and failed builds is improving. The total number of builds is decreasing, which would be expected because the team is committing less code and doing more code reviews. Of the total builds, the percentage of failed builds has gone down significantly. This is an indicator of better consistency in delivering working code and also an indicator of higher code quality.

So if their CI system was indicating that they were delivering quality code more consistently, why were they not hitting a consistent velocity? At a closer look they realized that even though their SCM data was fairly consistent, their velocity was not. Based on that, the team hypothesized that